PassFrame
TUITION

The Great Fire of London

Year 4 — 11+ Homework Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Non-fiction (History)

Extract — read it carefully before answering

In the early hours of 2nd September 1666, a small fire broke out in a baker's shop on Pudding Lane in the city of London. Nobody could have guessed that, within days, it would destroy most of the city.

London at the time was the perfect place for a fire to spread. The streets were narrow, and most houses were built from wood and covered in tar, which caught alight easily. A strong wind that night carried sparks from roof to roof, turning the small kitchen fire into an unstoppable blaze.

For four days, the fire raged across the city. Thousands of people fled with whatever belongings they could carry, some escaping onto the River Thames in rowing boats to watch helplessly as their homes burned. Even the great cathedral of St Paul's, built from stone, was not safe — the heat was so intense that its roof eventually melted and collapsed.

Remarkably, official records suggest that only a handful of people died in the fire itself, although historians believe the true number may never be known for certain. Over 13,000 houses and 87 churches were destroyed, leaving tens of thousands of Londoners homeless.

After the fire, London was rebuilt with wider streets and buildings made from brick and stone instead of wood, making the city far safer from fire in the future. The architect Christopher Wren designed a new St Paul's Cathedral, which still stands proudly in London today.

Questions

25 min · 12 questions

1. What type of shop did the fire start in?

2. How many days did the fire burn for?

3. Underline the sentence that tells you how some people escaped the fire.

4. Underline the sentence that names the architect who designed the new St Paul's Cathedral.

5. What does “unstoppable” mean as it is used to describe the fire?

6. Put these events in order: the fire spreads across the city / St Paul's Cathedral's roof collapses / a small fire starts on Pudding Lane / London is rebuilt with brick and stone.

7. Why might narrow streets have made the fire more dangerous?

8. What material were most London houses built from before the fire?

9. Why do you think the true number of deaths “may never be known for certain”?

10. What does the rebuilding of London suggest about how people learned from the disaster?

11. Find and copy a word that means “extremely strong and intense”, used to describe the fire's heat.

12. Write one or two sentences explaining what you think was the most important change made to London after the fire, and why.